

towards changing that behaviour. A good way to do this is to look through some past bank statements, or on your banking app, and pick out some purchases that you went on to regret. Write the item at the bottom of a piece of paper, and then see if you can work backwards through the circumstances surrounding that purchase, tracking the emotions that went along with it. For example, if the expense that bothered you was a takeaway that you didn't really want and hadn't budgeted for, maybe you can trace it back to feeling too exhausted to wash up or clean the kitchen, or to feeling frustrated that your partner never offers to cook, or just having a brain so busy that you couldn't even decide what you wanted.

Then, shooting off from the factors leading into that decision, make some suggestions for what you might have done differently to avoid travelling down that path. For example, could you have reinforced a boundary in asking your partner to share the cooking responsibilities with you? Could you have gone to bed earlier in order to feel more rested for today? Could you have listened to a meditation, podcast or audiobook to create some separation between your work day and your personal time?

You will never run out of things to buy

Here's the thing: you will never run out of things to buy. Our brains are hard-wired to want to finish things – it's why we